



BE READY.

In-season maintenance

Your sessions

Explosiveness + Power

Program

In-season maintenance

Duration

12 weeks

Session

30 to 40 min

Place

Home

For personal use only, do not share. This program is for people in good health: if you feel pain, have an injury or are in doubt, stop and ask a health professional for advice.

Your goals

Explosiveness

In handball, the decisive actions last less than 3 seconds: a first step to break into a gap, a change of direction to beat your opponent, a sprint back on defence.

- **Speed:** moving fast over a few metres.
- **Acceleration:** reaching your top speed as early as possible.
- **Changes of direction and agility:** braking, reorienting and setting off again without losing time.

The golden rules

- **Every rep flat out**, or nearly: quality matters more than quantity.
- **Recover fully** between reps: it is normal to wait.
- **Stop the set** if you slow down or your landings get heavy.
- Non-slip floor and shoes that hold your feet well.

Level 1: no more than **60 jumps** per session. Level 2: 80. Level 3: 100. Every landing counts as a jump.

Power

Power is force multiplied by speed. A jump shot, a duel at pivot or a first step all require producing a lot of force in a fraction of a second.

- **Push heavy:** increase your maximum strength with heavy loads and few reps.
- **Move fast:** turn that strength into fast movements (throws, jumps, pushes).
- **Link the two:** pair a heavy exercise with a similar fast movement (contrast method).

The golden rules

- **Few reps, lots of rest:** 3 to 5 reps, 2 to 3 minutes of recovery.
- **Every rep at maximum speed**, even with a heavy load: the intent is what counts.
- Heavy loads only if your technique is perfect.

At home: the load comes from a weighted backpack (books, water bottles), a handball or a band, and from single-leg variations.



Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it. Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

How to read your sessions

- Every session is written out in full, in order: do the steps from top to bottom.
- "2-4 × 8": 2 sets at level 1, 3 at level 2, 4 at level 3, of 8 reps. "2-3 × 8": 2 sets at levels 1 and 2, 3 at level 3.
- The number in front of each exercise refers to its illustrated sheet, at the end of this document.
- If you do not know your level, read the guide again, page "Choosing your level".

Your two sessions

The sessions are the same for all 12 weeks. **Weeks 4, 8 and 12 are lighter:** do one set less on each exercise. Weeks 1 to 3, 5 to 7 and 9 to 11: sessions as written, aiming for an effort of 7-8 out of 10.

Timing: session 1 at least 3 days before the match, session 2 no later than 2 days before. Never the day before a match.

Session 1 · the more demanding one, far from the match

1 WARM-UP

8 min

1	Light jog and running drills	2 min	
2	Forward lunge with trunk rotation	5 per side	
3	Glute bridge	1 × 10	
4	Plank	1 × 20 s	
5	Single-leg balance	20 s per leg	
6	Small jump, stable landing	1 × 5	
7	Progressive accelerations (70 %, then 85 %)	2 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS

10-12 min

8	Squat jump	2-3 × 4	75 s
9	10 m starts	4-5 runs	75 s

3 POWER

10-12 min

10	Weighted Bulgarian split squat (or heavy hip thrust)	2-3 × 6 per leg · 3 s descent	3 min
11	Rotational throw	2 × 4 per side	60 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

12	Nordic hamstring curl	2 × 3-5	60 s
13	Copenhagen plank (knee version)	2 × 15 s per side	30 s
4	Plank	1-2 × 30 s	30 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

Session 2 · lighter

1 WARM-UP

8 min

1	Light jog and running drills	2 min	
2	Forward lunge with trunk rotation	5 per side	
3	Glute bridge	1 × 10	
4	Plank	1 × 20 s	
5	Single-leg balance	20 s per leg	
6	Small jump, stable landing	1 × 5	
7	Progressive accelerations (70 %, then 85 %)	2 runs	walk back

2 EXPLOSIVENESS

10-12 min

14	Pogos	2 × 10	45 s
15	5-10-5 shuttle	3 runs	90 s
16	Reactive starts	4-6 runs	60 s

3 POWER

10-12 min

17	Box jump	2-3 × 3	90 s
18	Two-handed ball throw	2-3 × 4	60 s

4 CORE AND PREVENTION

5-8 min

19	Shoulder external rotation	2 × 12 per arm	30 s
20	Y-T-W	2 × 8	30 s
21	Balance with a ball	2 × 20 s per leg	20 s

5 COOL-DOWN

5 min

2 minutes of walking, then light stretches of 20 to 30 seconds, without forcing: hip flexors, quads, hamstrings, calves, chest and shoulders.

The exercises

In the order of the numbers used in your sessions.



Important: watch each exercise's animation before doing it. Tap the eye next to its name. The animation shows what the text cannot: the exact position, the direction of the movement, the rhythm and the footwork. Do not just read the program, especially for an exercise you do not know: this is what makes every session effective and safe.

1 Light jog and running drills

Light jog, alternating side shuffles, high knees and butt kicks.

Key points: Start slowly, then gradually pick up the pace.



2 Forward lunge with trunk rotation

Arms straight out in front of you, take a big step forward and lower into a lunge, then turn your trunk and arms towards the front leg. Come back and switch legs.

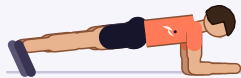
Key points: Front knee above the ankle, slow rotation.



3 Glute bridge

On your back, knees bent, feet on the floor, lift your hips until shoulders, hips and knees are in line, then lower.

Key points: Squeeze your glutes at the top, do not arch your lower back. Also contract your pelvic floor (as if holding in urine): it protects against leaks, especially for women and older people.



4 Plank

On your forearms and toes, body in a straight line from head to heels.

Key points: Squeeze your glutes and abs, breathe normally.

Easier: Knees on the floor.



5 Single-leg balance

On one foot, knee slightly bent, the other foot off the floor behind you, arms relaxed: hold the position without moving. To progress: close your eyes, then stand on a cushion.

Key points: The knee stays over the foot, the pelvis level.



6



Small jump, stable landing

Small jump on the spot, land softly on both feet and hold the position for 2 seconds.

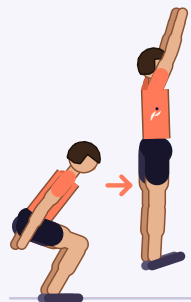
Key points: Land on the balls of your feet, knees bent and in line with your toes: they never cave inwards. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

7

Progressive accelerations

Run 15 m, building up speed: 60 %, then 80 %, then 90 % of your top speed. Walk back.

Key points: Relaxed, shoulders loose.



8

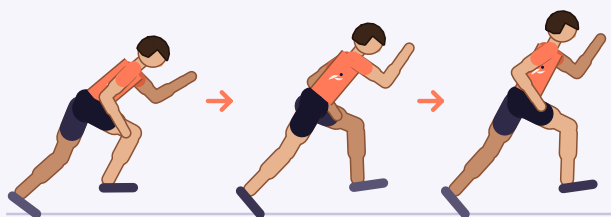


Squat jump

Lower into a half squat, pause for one second, then jump as high as you can. Stable landing.

Key points: Push hard into the floor, arms helping. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

Easier: Without the pause.



9 10 m starts

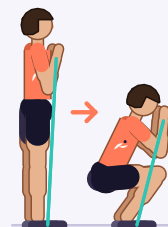
Split-stance start, trunk leaning forward. Sprint flat out for 10 m.

Key points: Short, powerful first steps, arms driving back.

At home



With a band



10 Weighted Bulgarian split squat

Back foot resting on the sofa or a chair, weighted backpack on your back: lower on the front leg over 3 seconds, then stand up as fast as possible.

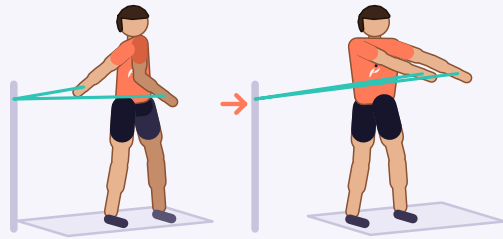
With a band: Squat with a strong band under your feet, held at your shoulders, 2-second pause at the bottom.

Key points: Controlled descent, stand up as fast as possible.

At home



With a band



11

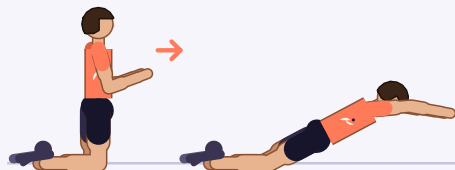


Rotational throw

Side-on to an outside wall, ball held at your hip, pivot and throw sideways, like a shot. Without a ball: fast trunk rotations, arms straight.

With a band: Band anchored to the side at hip height: rotate your trunk as fast as possible, pulling the band.

Key points: The movement starts from the hips, not the arms.



12

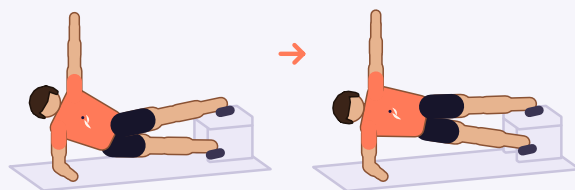


Nordic hamstring curl

Kneeling on a cushion, feet anchored under the sofa or held by another person, lean forward as slowly as possible, body straight. Catch yourself with your hands, then push back up with your hands.

Key points: Hips extended: the body stays straight from the knees to the head.

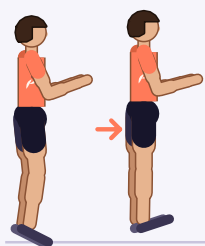
Easier: Shorter descent.



13 Copenhagen plank

On your side, on your forearm (elbow under the shoulder), top leg resting on the sofa or a chair (at the knee, or at the foot to make it harder). Lift your hips, reach your top arm up to the ceiling and hold the position.

Key points: Body in line: the inside of the top thigh does the work.

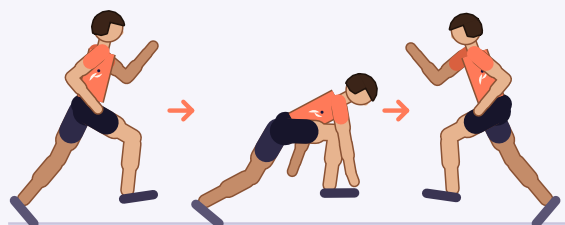


14 Pogos

Small quick jumps on the spot, legs almost straight: your ankles do the bouncing.

Key points: Shortest possible ground contact. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

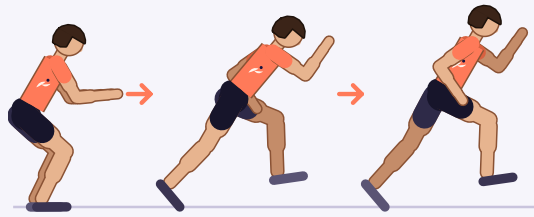
Easier: Lower jumps, slower rhythm.



15 5-10-5 shuttle

Start in the middle: 5 m to the right (touch the line), 10 m to the left (touch), back to the middle.

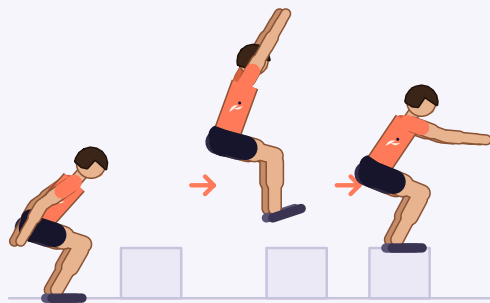
Key points: Get low before each change of direction, push off with the outside leg.



16 Reactive starts

Start on a partner's signal (clap, voice) or react to a dropped ball. Vary the starting position: facing forward (as in the animation), facing backward, side shuffling.

Key points: React, don't guess.

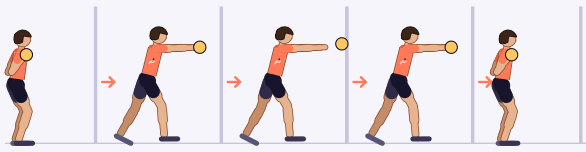


17 Box jump

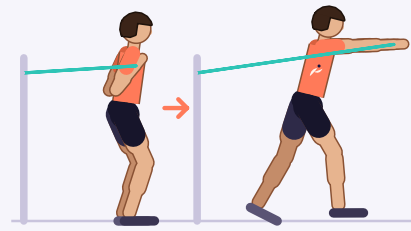
Jump onto a stair step or a very stable bench, land softly, step back down. Without a stable support: squat jump.

Key points: Jump high, not far. Stepping down protects your tendons. In the air, pull your toes up towards your shins (locked ankle), ready for the landing.

At home



With a band



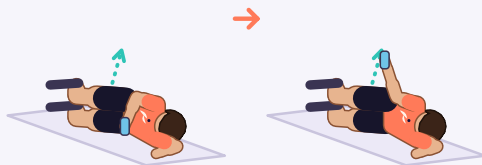
18 Two-handed ball throw

Facing an outside wall, handball or basketball at your chest, throw as hard as you can. Without a ball: plyometric push-ups.

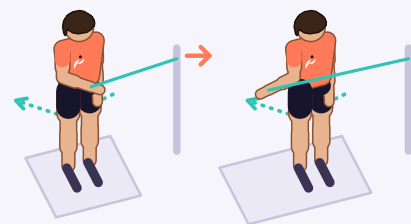
With a band: Band anchored behind you at chest height: push forward as fast as possible.

Key points: Push with your legs and arms at the same time.

At home



With a band



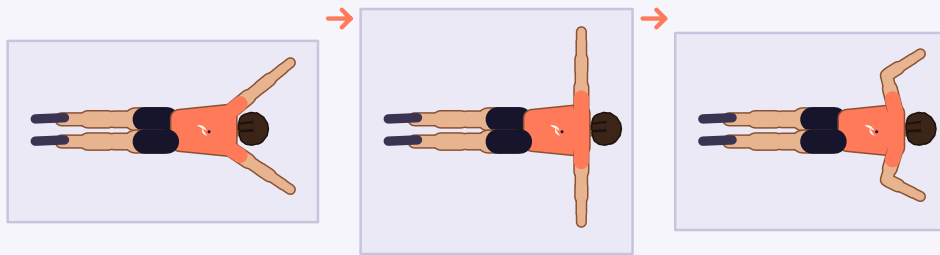
19 Shoulder external rotation

Lying on your side, top elbow tucked against your waist and bent at 90°, a water bottle in your hand, forearm resting in front of your belly: lift your forearm towards the ceiling by pivoting around the elbow (the hand moves away from your belly), then lower slowly.

With a band: Standing, band anchored to the side: elbow tucked in, move your forearm outwards.

Key points: The elbow does not move, 2 seconds on the way back.

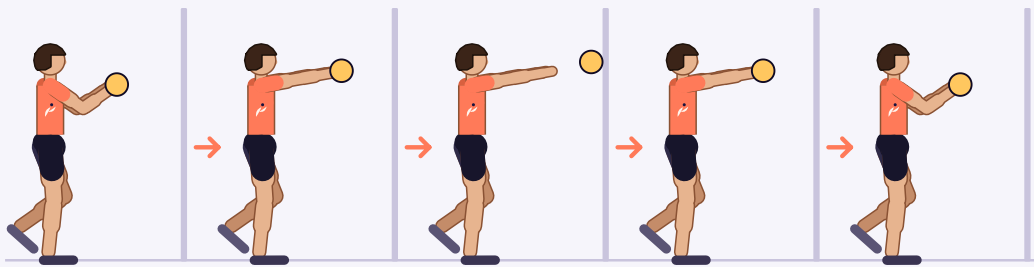
Easier: Without a band.



20 Y-T-W

Lying face down, forehead on a towel. Lift your arms off the floor to draw three letters with your body: Y (arms straight, diagonally above your head), T (arms out to the sides), then W (elbows bent, pulled in close to your ribs). Hold each letter for 2 seconds, squeezing your shoulder blades.

Key points: Thumbs towards the ceiling, no arching.



21 Balance with a ball

On one leg, throw a ball against a wall and catch it. Harder: standing on a folded cushion.

Key points: The standing knee stays in line.